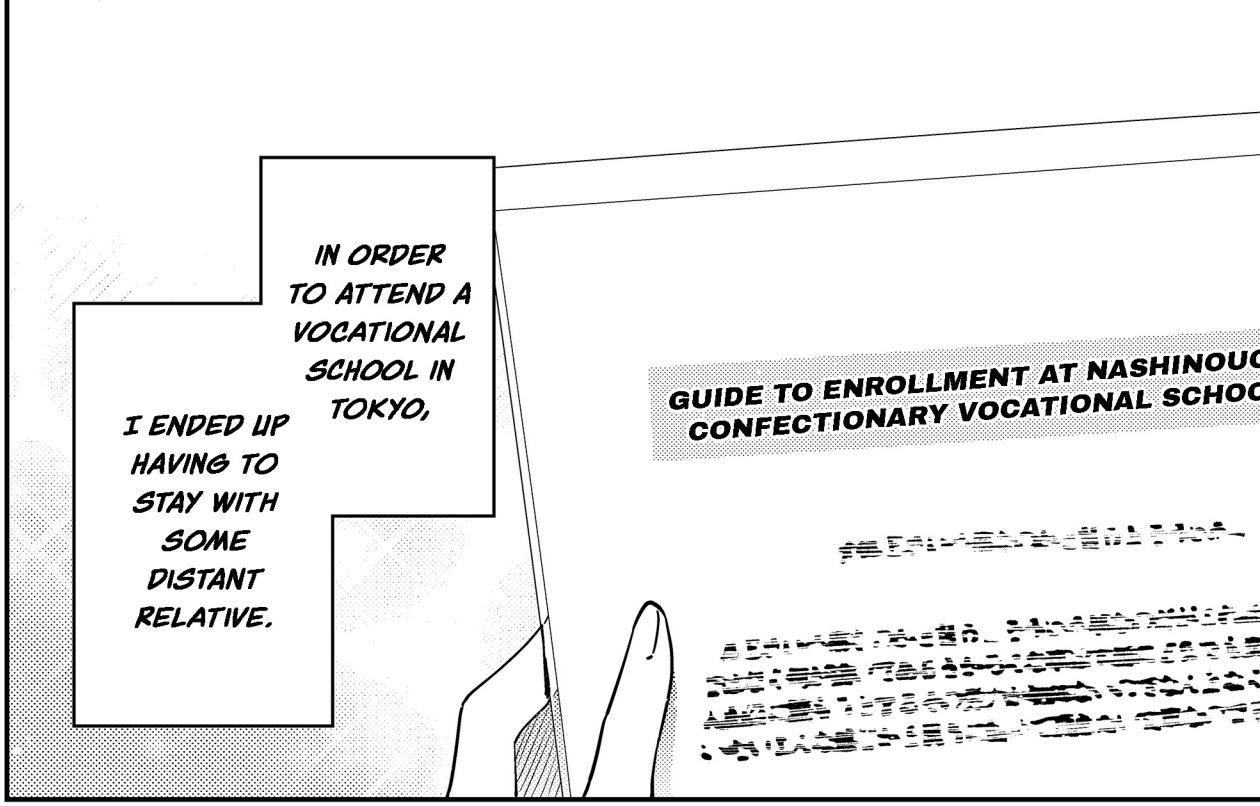
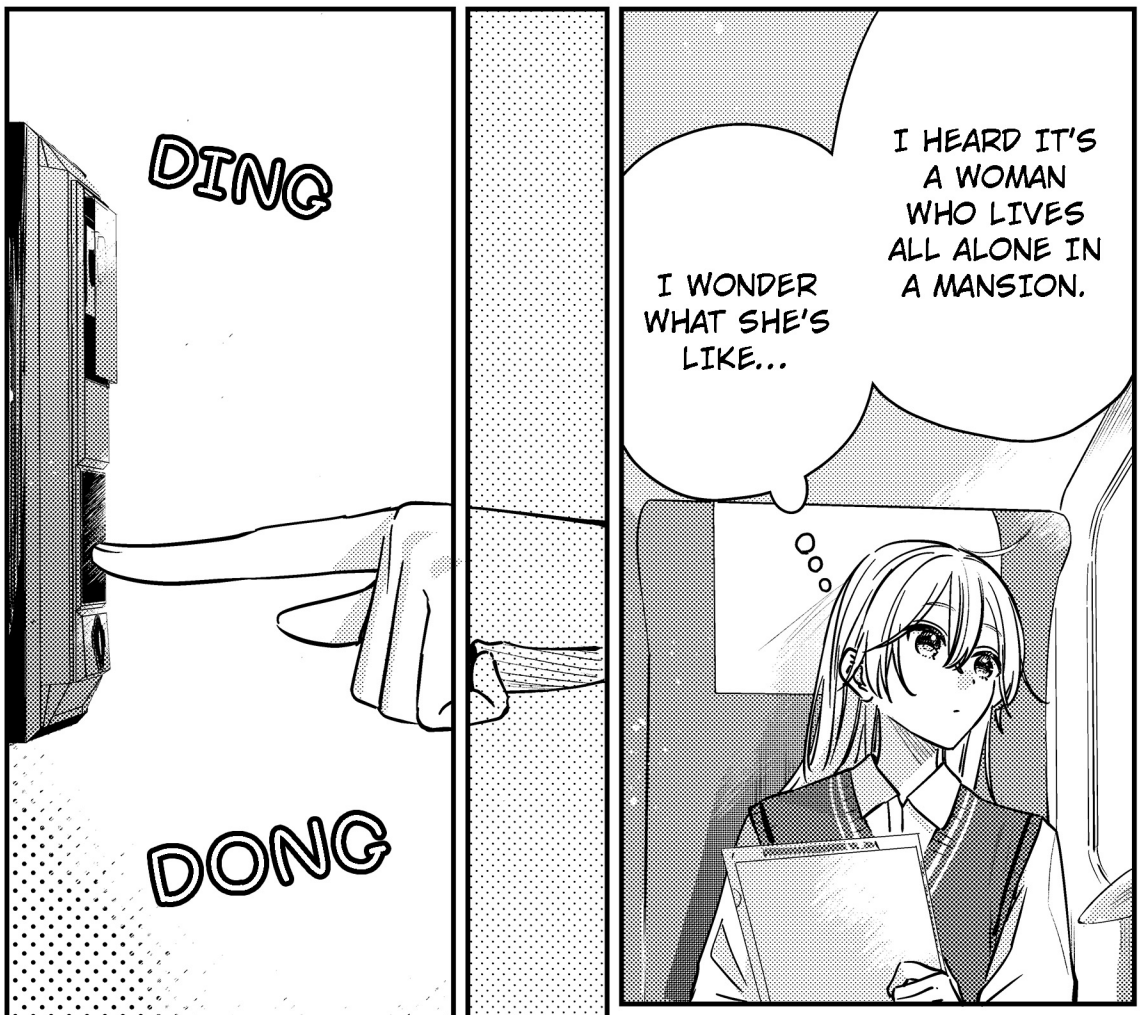
Shall we
Afternoon Tea
for Two
Shall we have afternoon tea tog
have tea together?
MEI FUJIMATSU
HARU SATSUKI

RITSU,
YOU DIDN'T FORGET ANYTHING?
YES.
DO YOUR BEST WITH YOUR NEW LIFE, OKAY?
I'M OFF!
WHOOSH

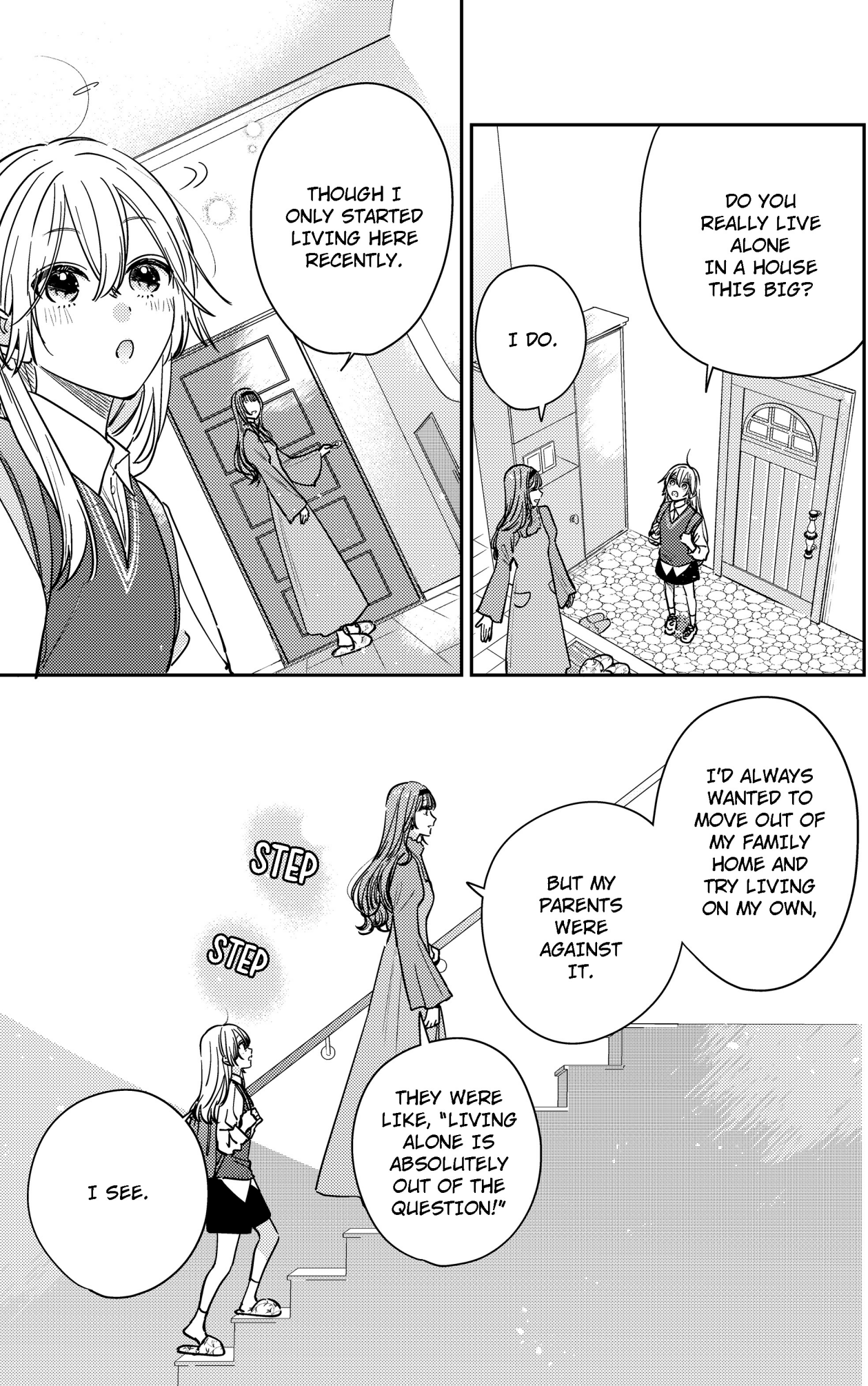

IN ORDER TO ATTEND A VOCATIONAL SCHOOL IN TOKYO,
I ENDED UP HAVING TO STAY WITH SOME DISTANT RELATIVE.
GUIDE TO ENROLLMENT AT NASHINOUC
CONFECTIONARY VOCATIONAL SCHOC

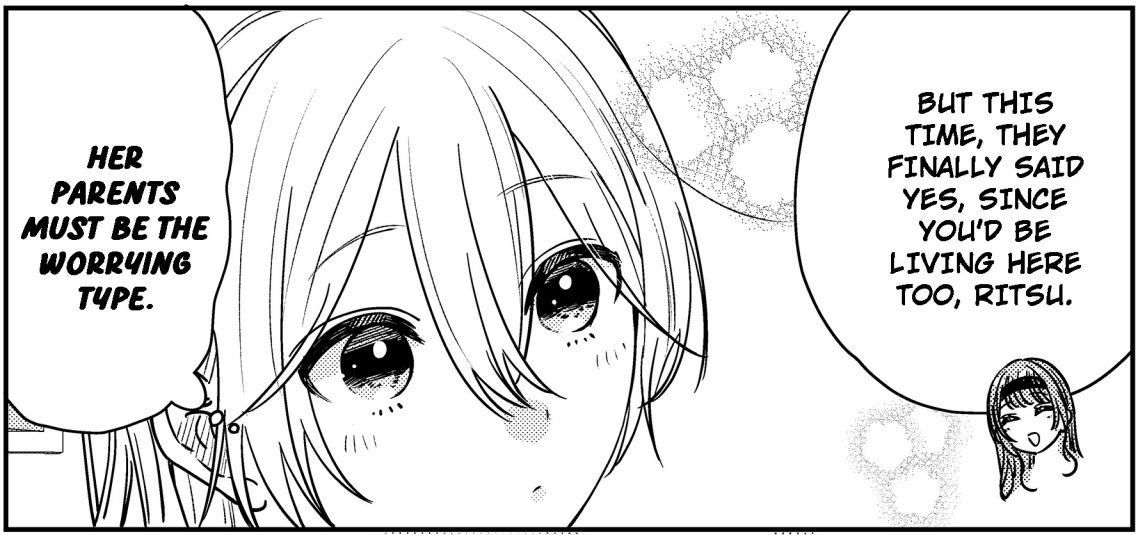

DING
DONG
I HEARD IT'S A WOMAN WHO LIVES ALL ALONE IN A MANSION.
I WONDER WHAT SHE'S LIKE...

WHAT AN AMAZING HOUSE...

ARE YOU RITSU?

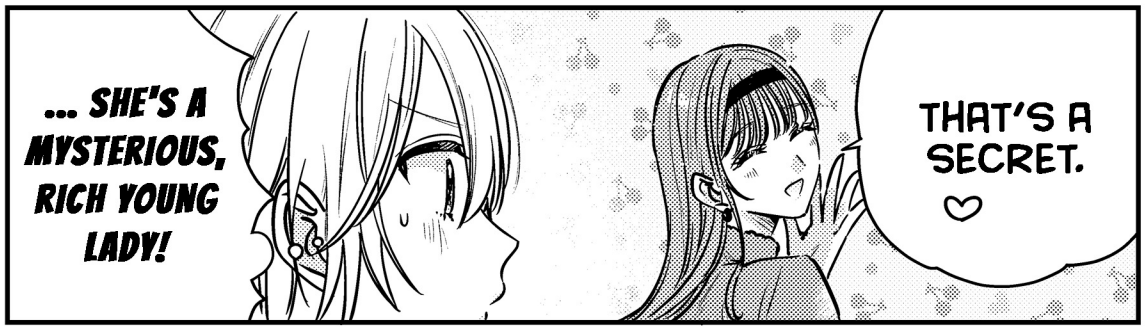
SHE'S SO UNBELIEVABLY BEAUTIFUL...!
MY NAME IS SERIZAWA RITSU, AND I'LL BE IN YOUR CARE STARTING TODAY!
N-NICE TO MEET YOU!
NICE TO MEET YOU.
CLACK
YES!
YOU CAN JUST CALL ME MITSURUKO.

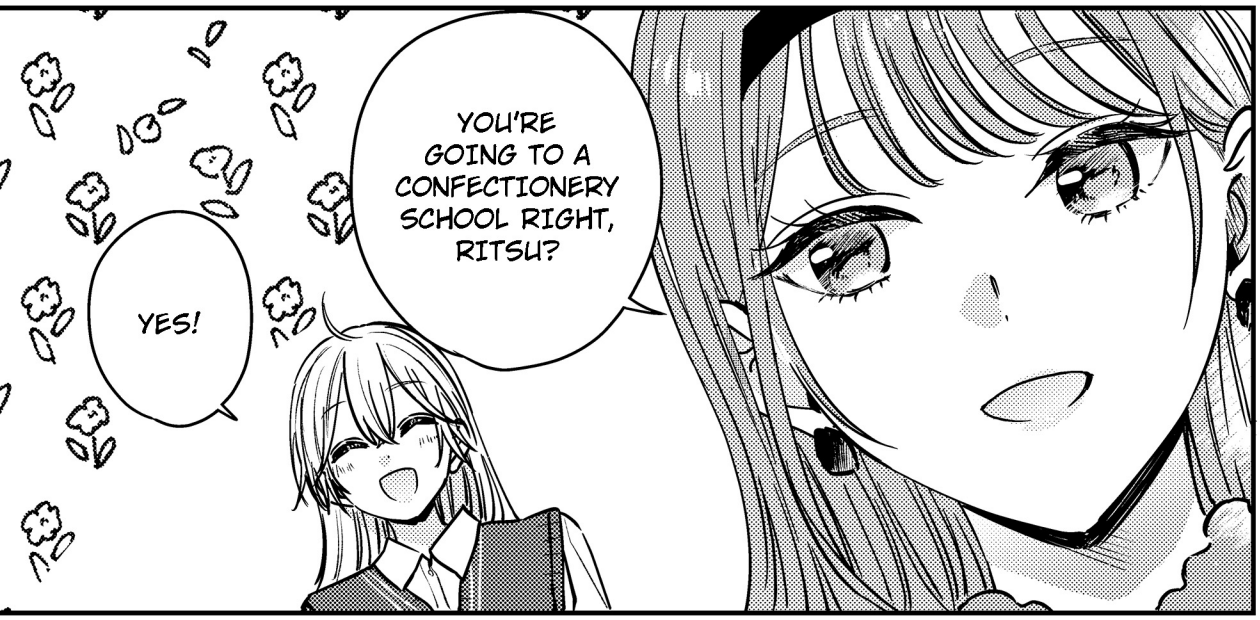

THOUGH I ONLY STARTED LIVING HERE RECENTLY.
DO YOU REALLY LIVE ALONE IN A HOUSE THIS BIG?
I DO.
I'D ALWAYS WANTED TO MOVE OUT OF MY FAMILY HOME AND TRY LIVING ON MY OWN,
BUT MY PARENTS WERE AGAINST IT.
THEY WERE LIKE, "LIVING ALONE IS ABSOLUTELY OUT OF THE QUESTION!"
STEP
STEP
I SEE.

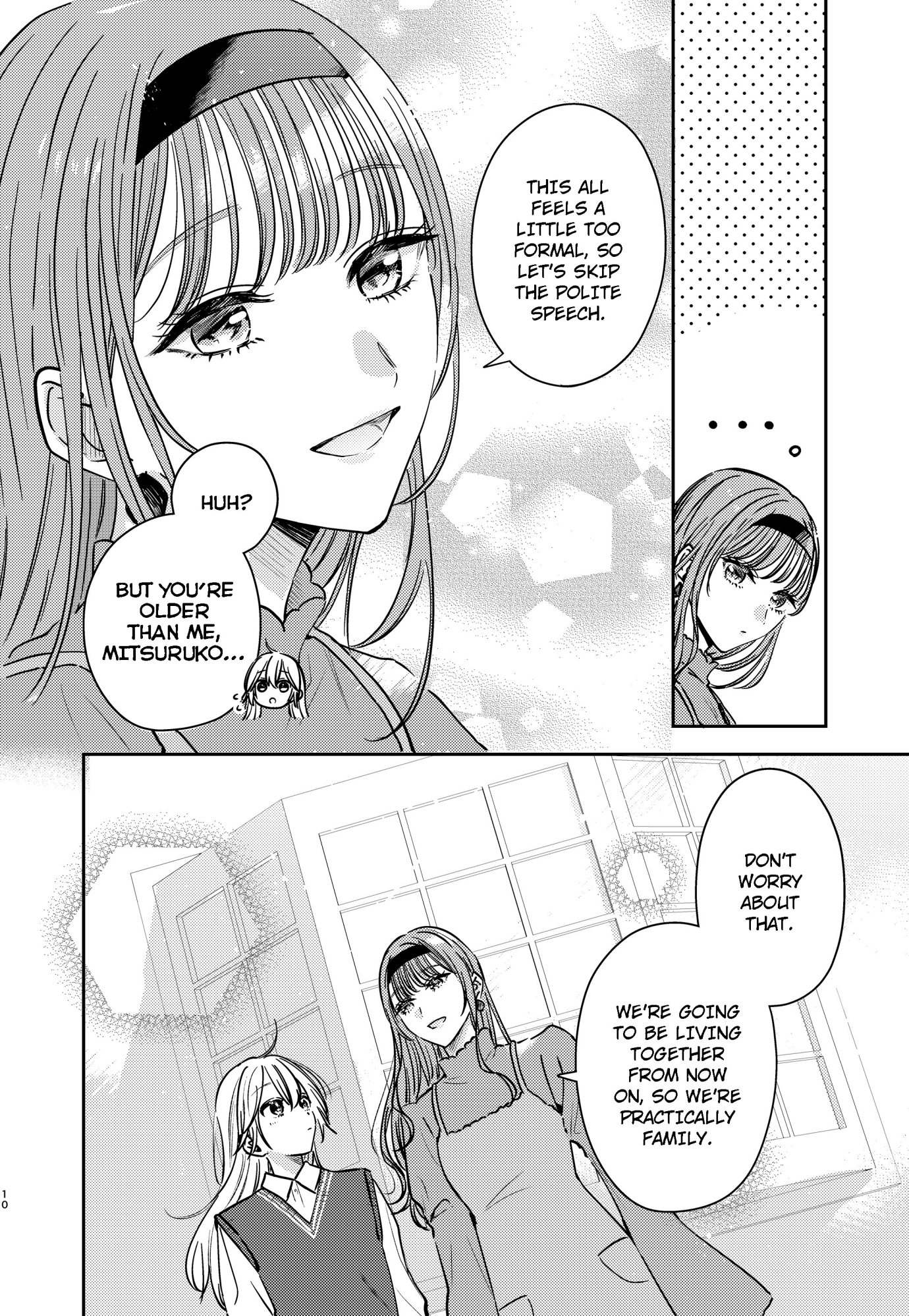

HER PARENTS MUST BE THE WORRYING TYPE.
BUT THIS TIME, THEY FINALLY SAID YES, SINCE YOU'D BE LIVING HERE TOO, RITSU.

I'M GLAD.
IT'S SO CUTE!
THIS IS YOUR ROOM, RITSU.
RITSU

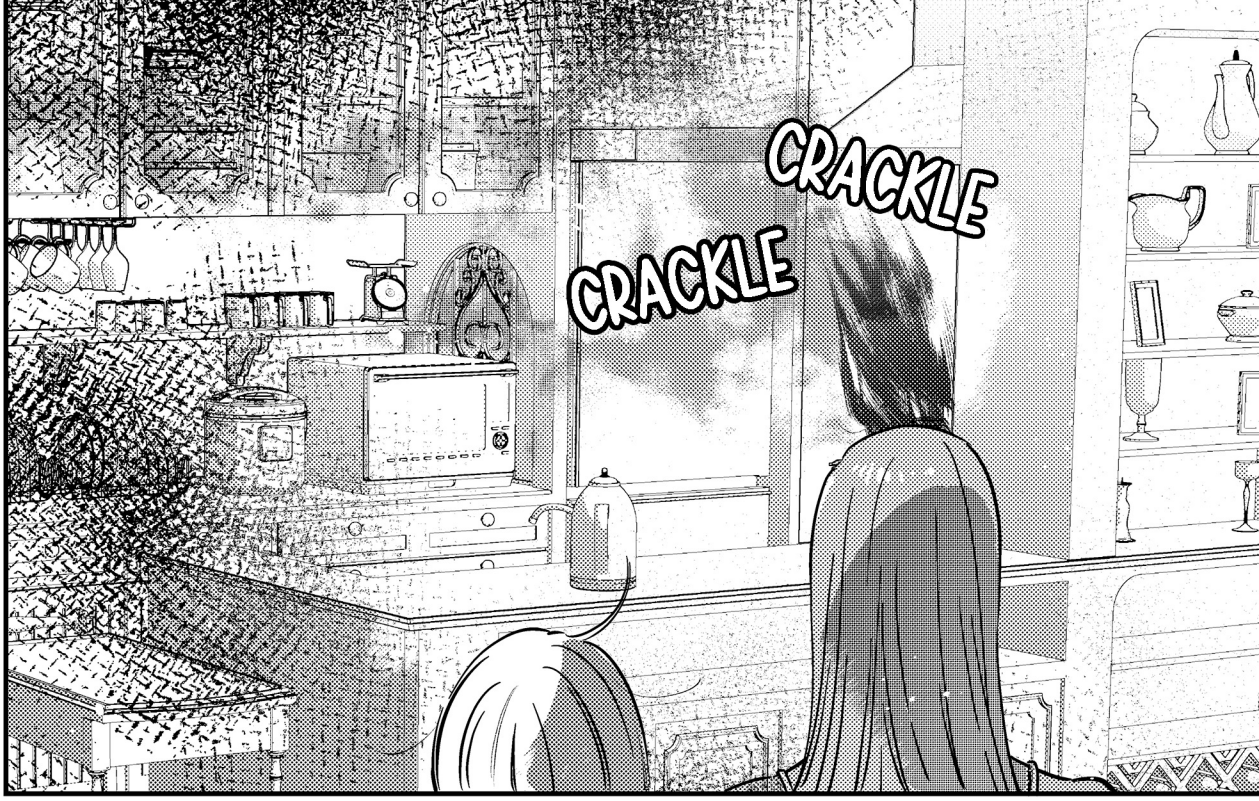
THIS AMAZING HOUSE... YOU BUILT IT YOURSELF, DIDN'T YOU, MITSURUKO?
JUST WHAT KIND OF JOB DO YOU EVEN HAVE...?
...

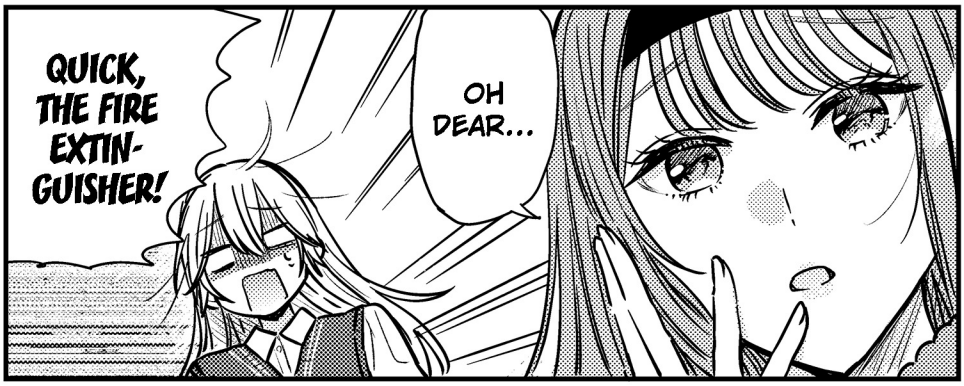

THAT'S A SECRET. ♡
... SHE'S A MYSTERIOUS, RICH YOUNG LADY!

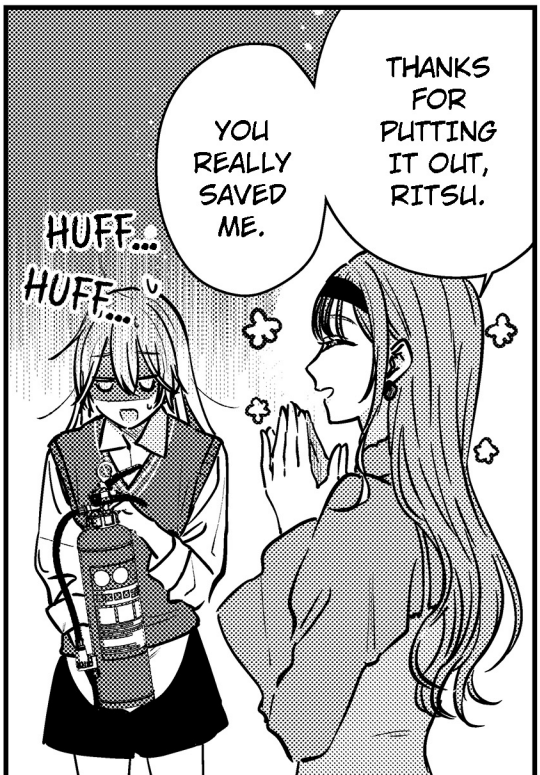

YOU'RE GOING TO A CONFECTIONERY SCHOOL RIGHT, RITSU?
YES!


THIS ALL FEELS A LITTLE TOO FORMAL, SO LET'S SKIP THE POLITE SPEECH.
HUH?
BUT YOU'RE OLDER THAN ME, MITSURUKO...
DON'T WORRY ABOUT THAT.
WE'RE GOING TO BE LIVING TOGETHER FROM NOW ON, SO WE'RE PRACTICALLY FAMILY.

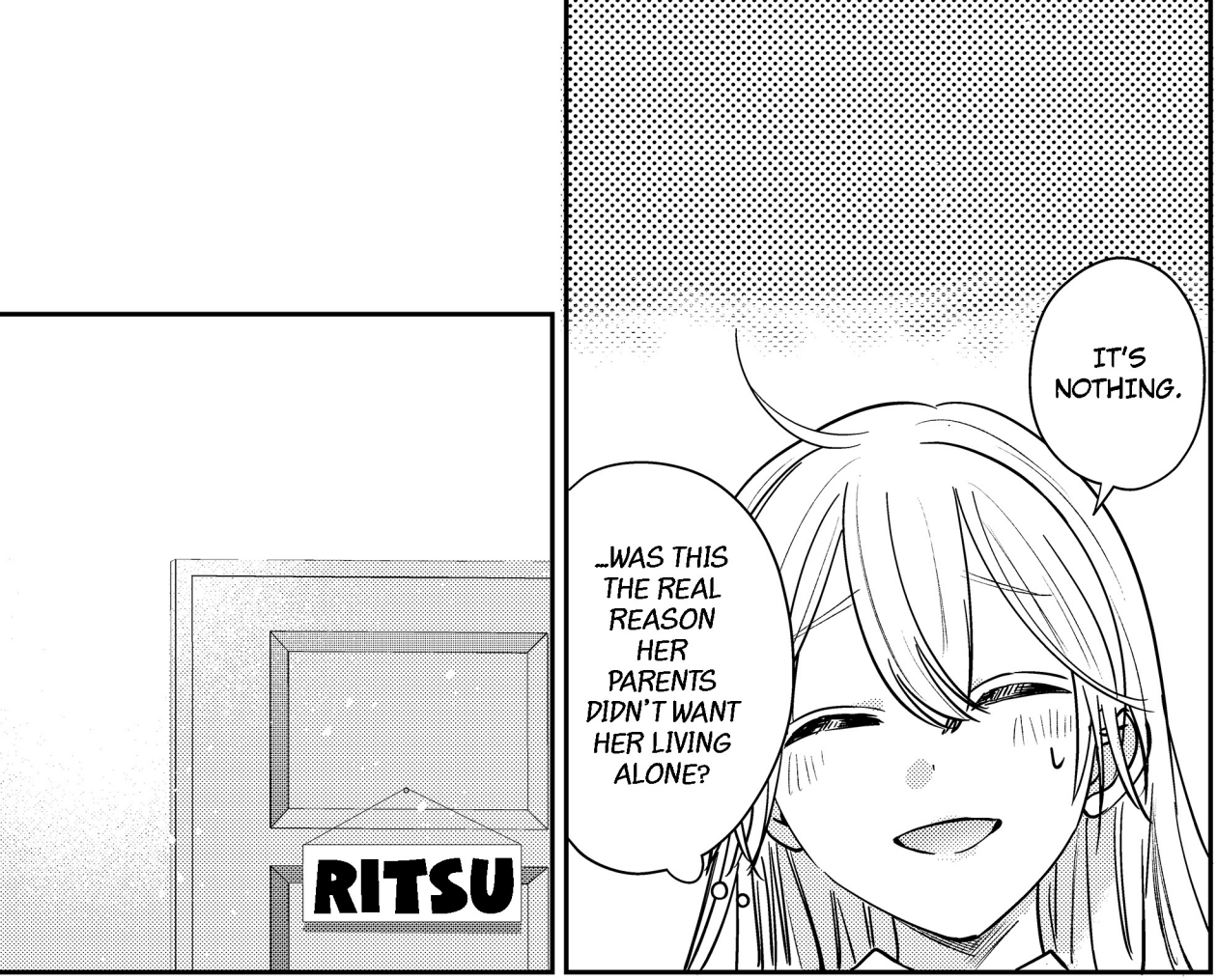
...OKAY!
Right, Right.
I WAS GETTING READY TO THROW YOU A WELCOME PARTY, RITSU.
WOW, THANK YOU!
...BUT WHY DOES SOMETHING SMELL BURNT?
SNIFF

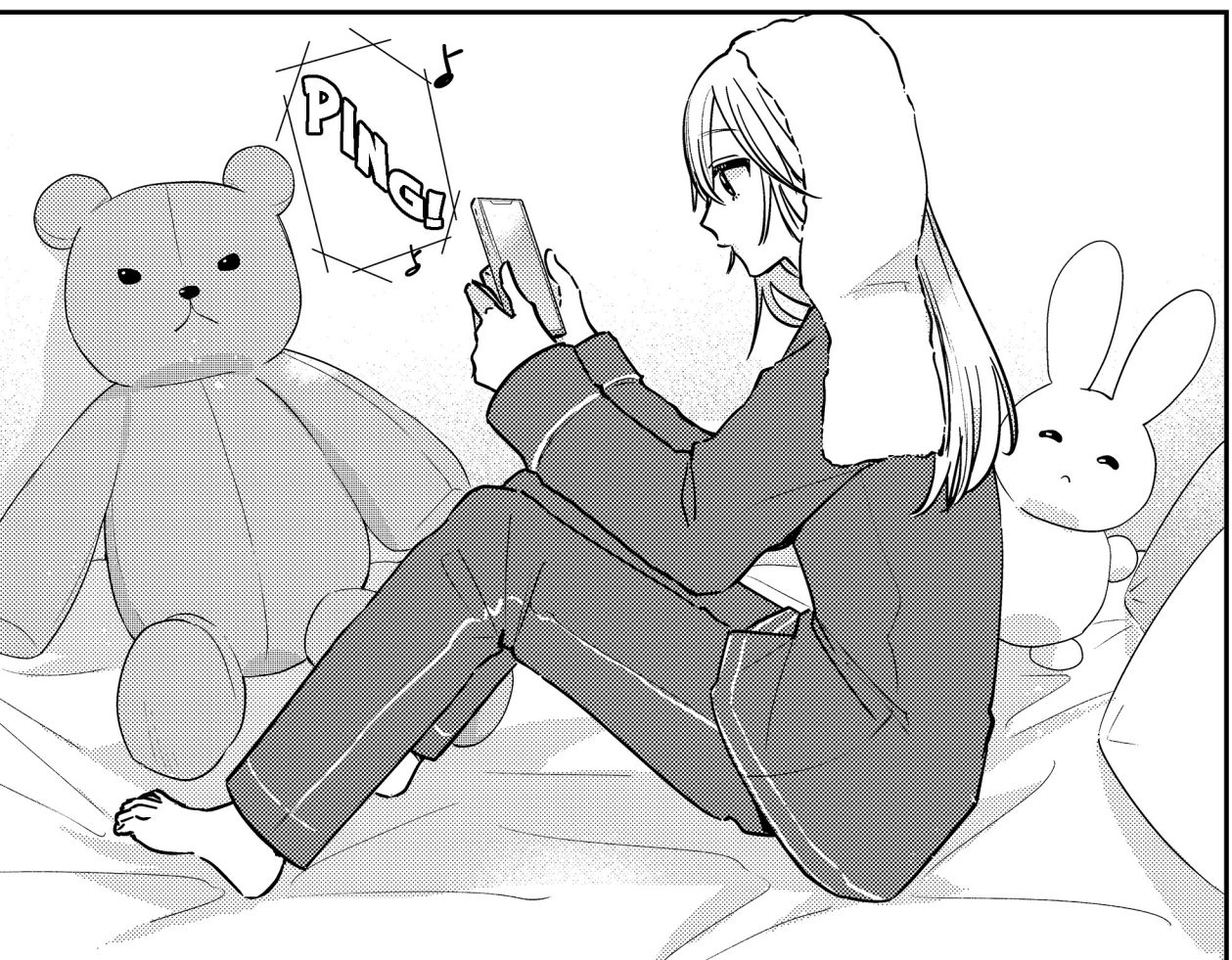

CRACKLE
CRACKLE

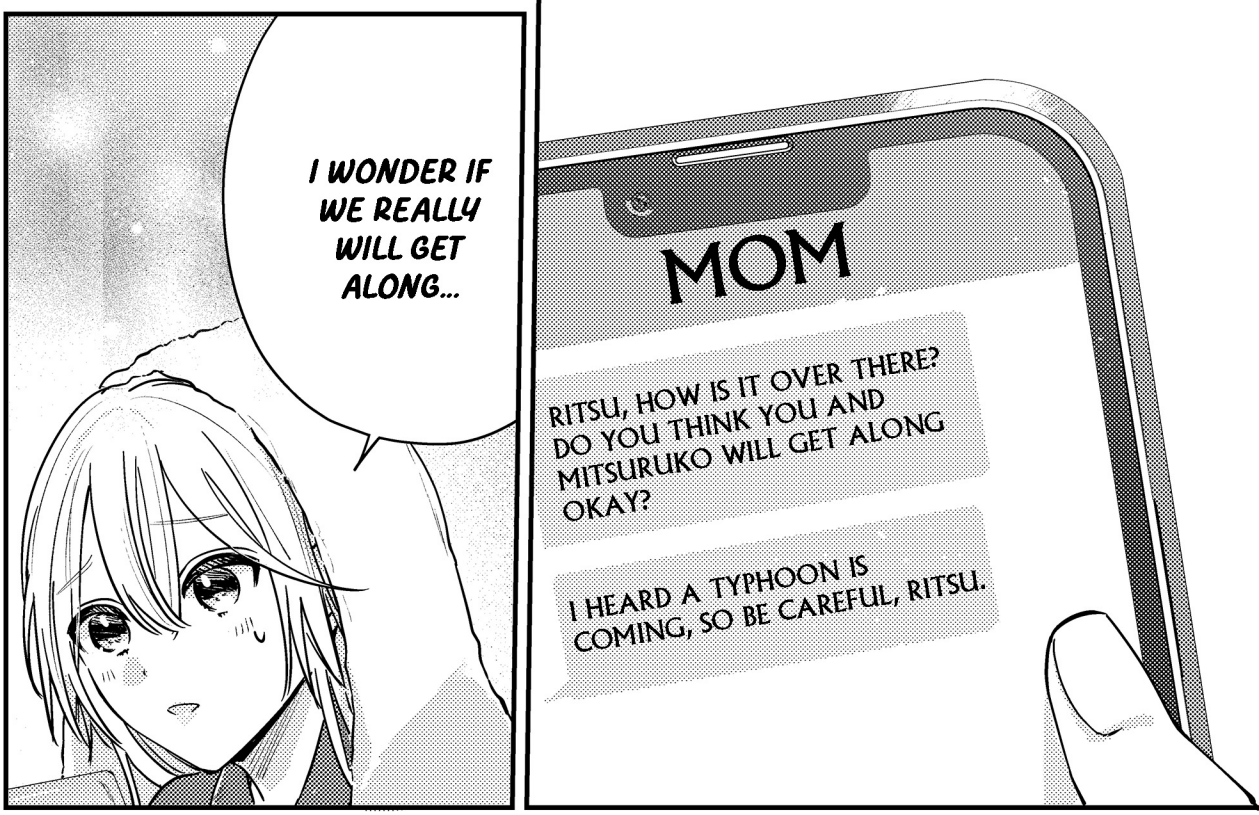

QUICK, THE FIRE EXTIN-GUISHER!
OH DEAR...

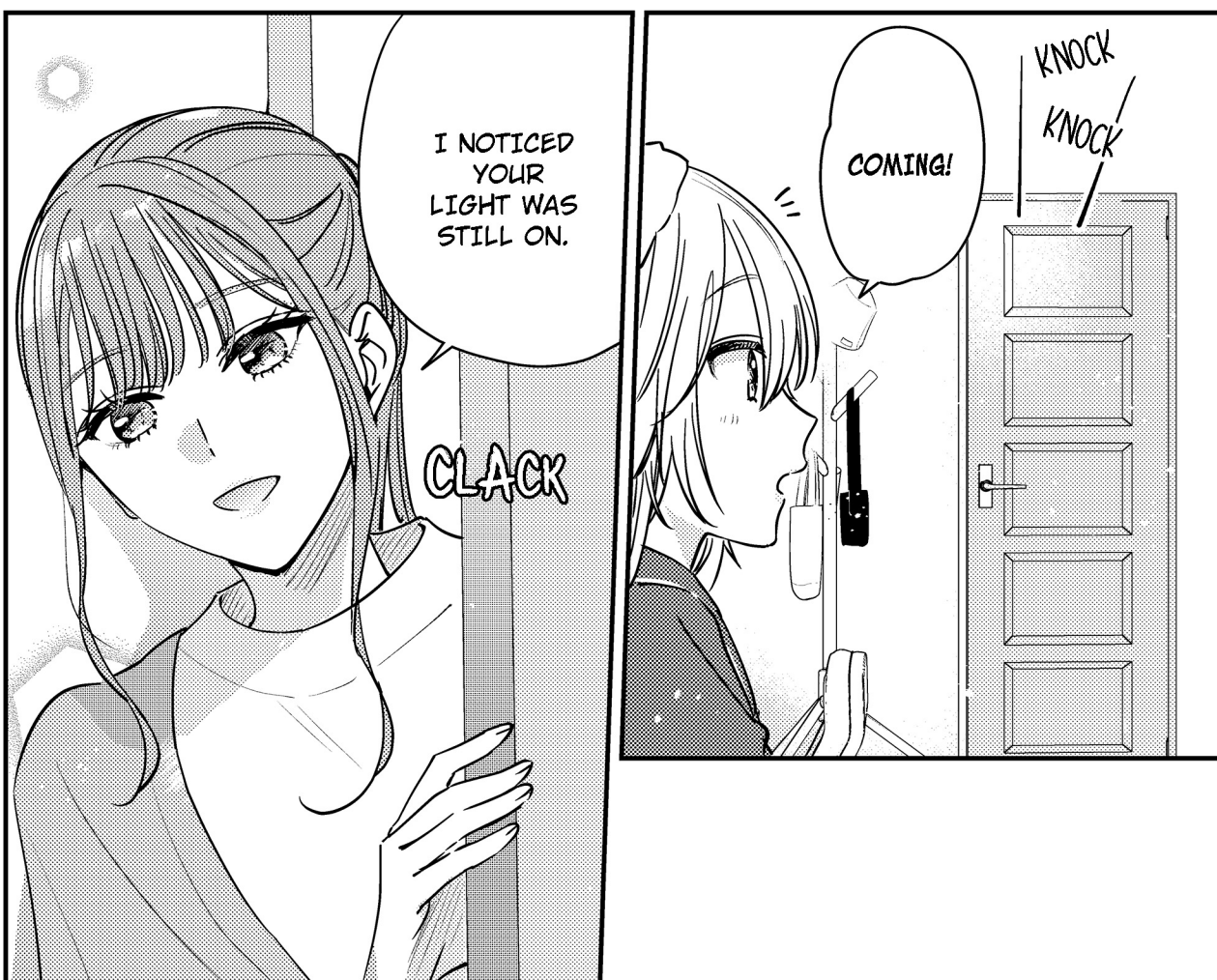

HUFF... HUFF...
YOU REALLY SAVED ME.
THANKS FOR PUTTING IT OUT, RITSU.

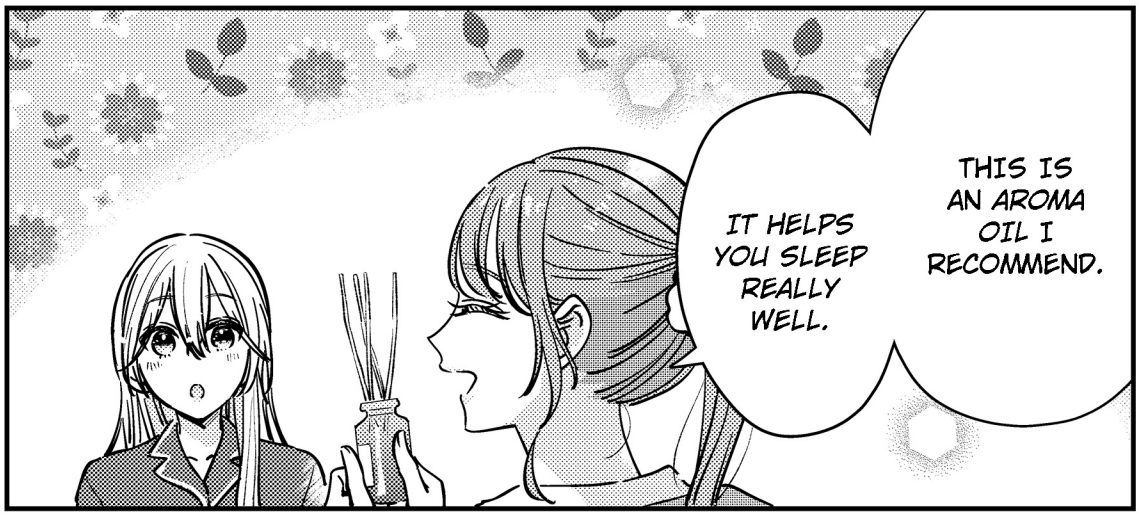
LOOKS LIKE DINNER GOT BURNED.


RITSU
...WAS THIS THE REAL REASON HER PARENTS DIDN'T WANT HER LIVING ALONE?
IT'S NOTHING.


PING!


I WONDER IF WE REALLY WILL GET ALONG...
MOM
RITSU, HOW IS IT OVER THERE? DO YOU THINK YOU AND MITSURUKO WILL GET ALONG OKAY?
I HEARD A TYPHOON IS COMING, SO BE CAREFUL, RITSU.


KNOCK
KNOCK
COMING!
I NOTICED YOUR LIGHT WAS STILL ON.
CLACK

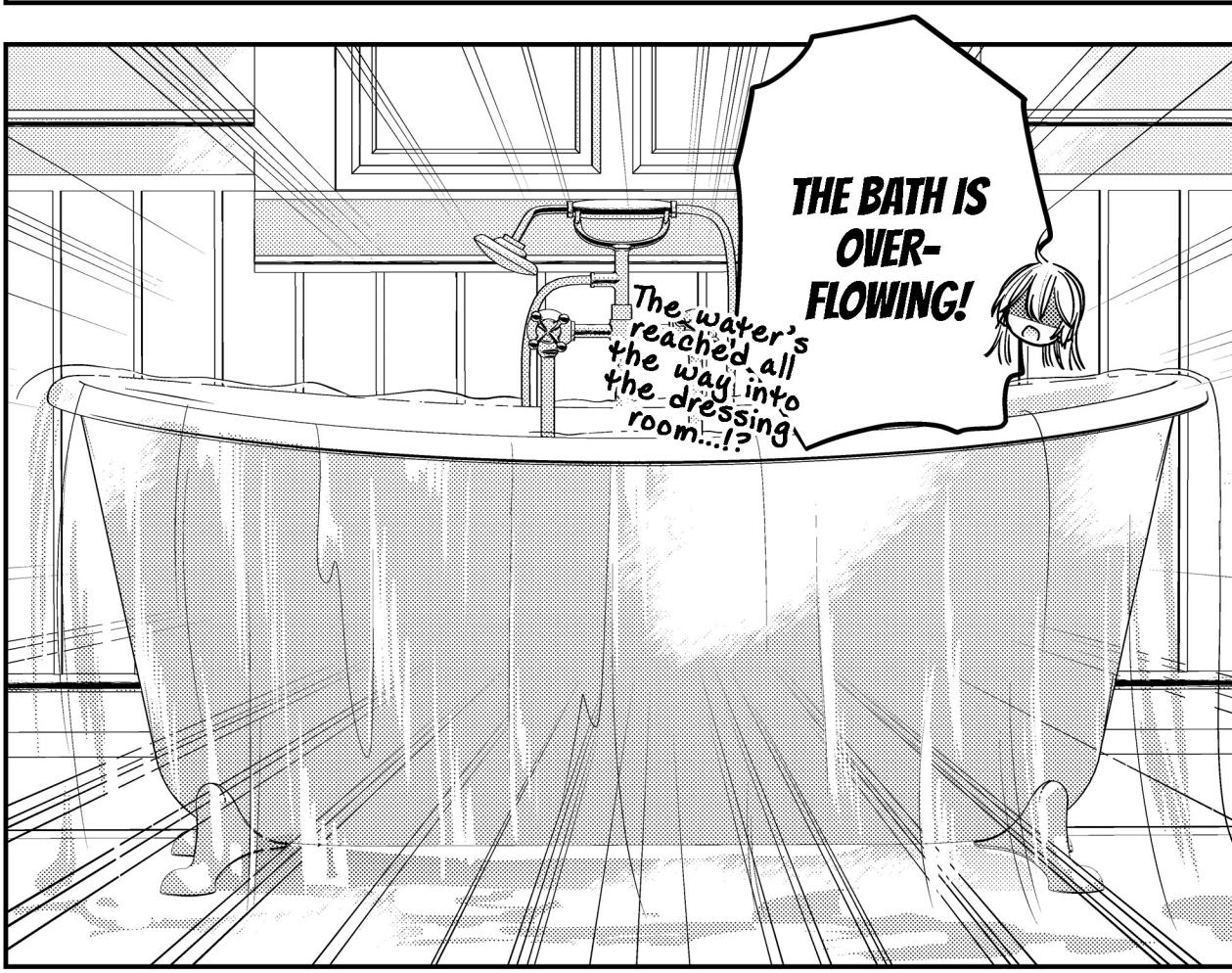

THIS IS AN AROMA OIL I RECOMMEND.
IT HELPS YOU SLEEP REALLY WELL.

IT SMELLS AMAZING.

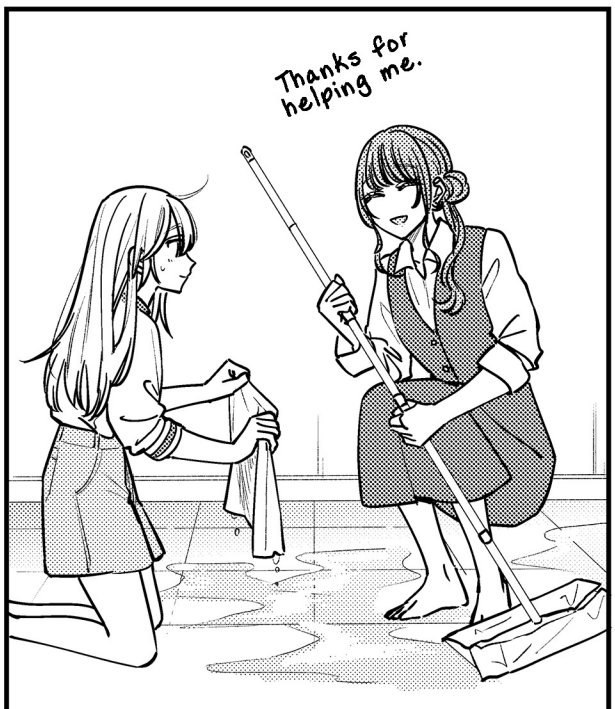
THANK YOU.

SEND!
MITSURUKO IS KIND TOO, SO I'M SURE IT'LL BE FINE!

...THE NEXT DAY...

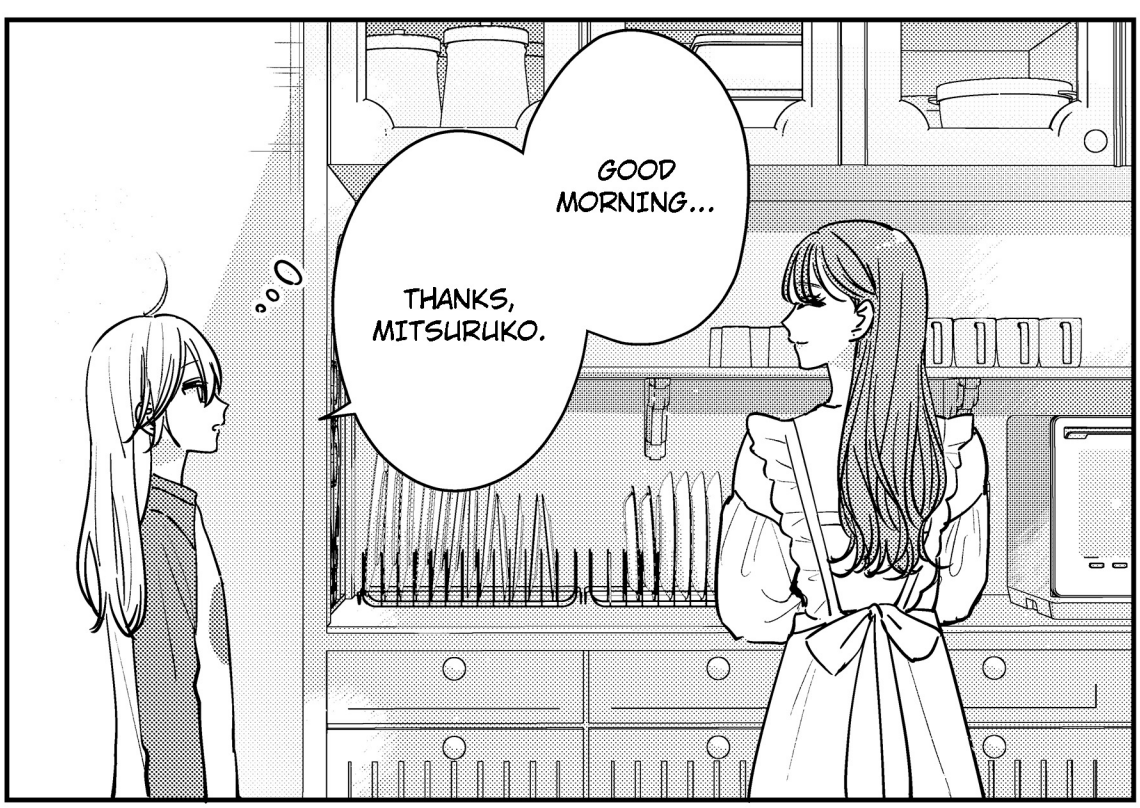

THE BATH IS OVER-FLOWING!
The water's reached all the way into the dressing room...!?

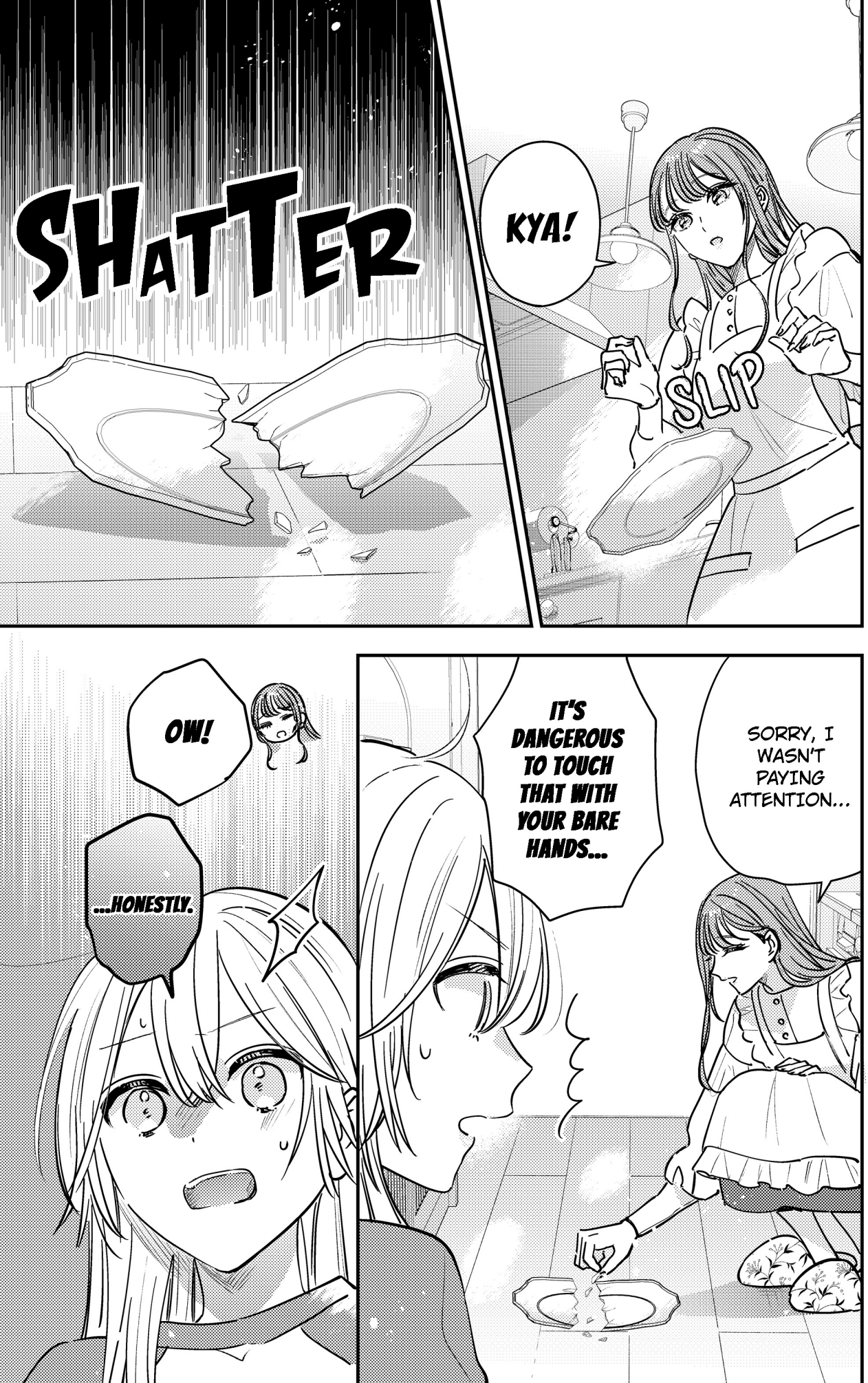
MITSURUKO IS...

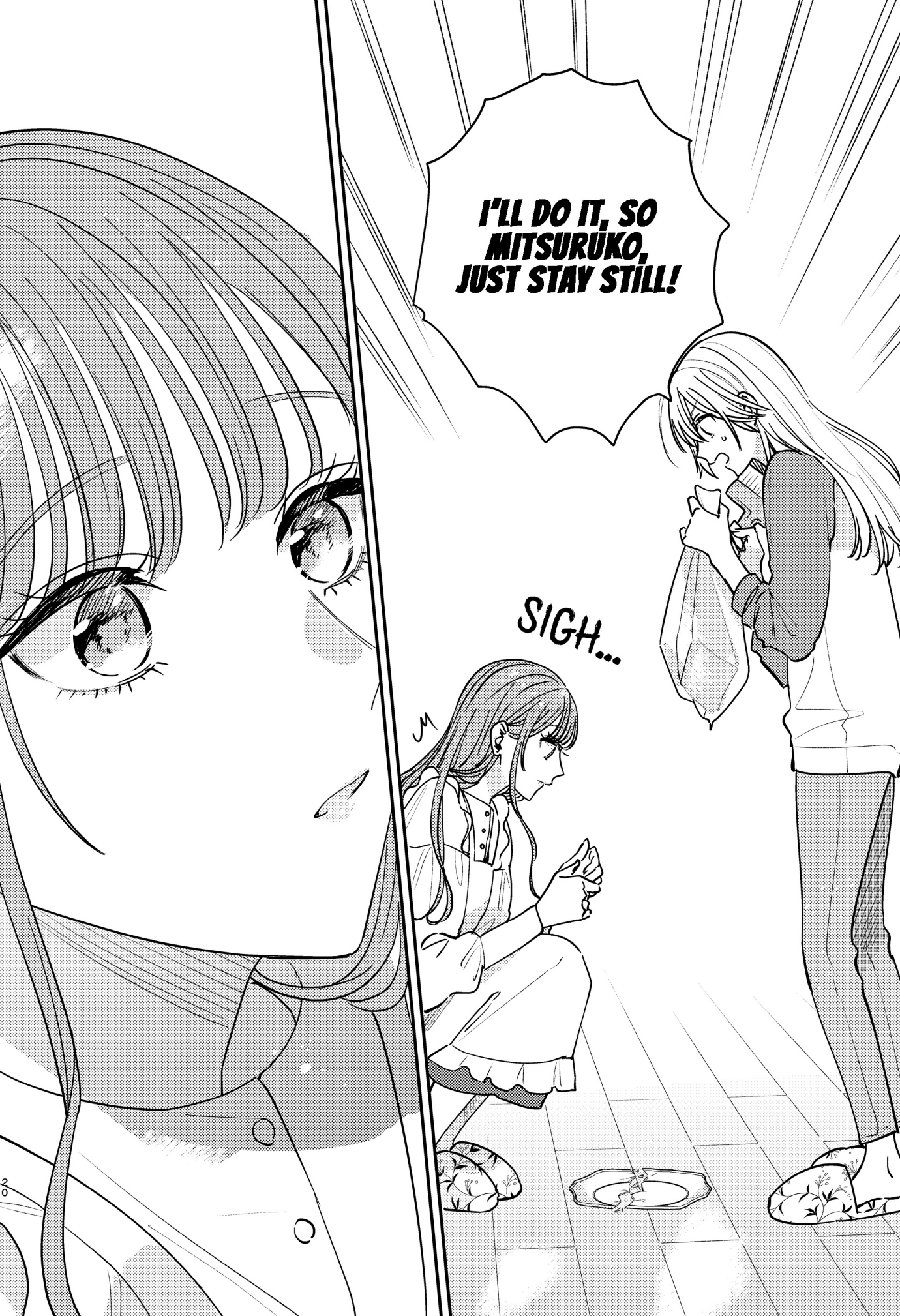

Thanks for helping me.

A GOOD PERSON, BUT...
LET'S HAVE A PICNIC IN THE GARDEN!
I THINK I MIXED UP THE SUGAR AND SALT...
DROOL...
NOM
SHE'S KIND OF A DISASTER...?

RISE...
I MADE BREAKFAST!
LET'S EAT TOGETHER!
RITSUUU!


GOOD MORNING...
THANKS, MITSURUKO.

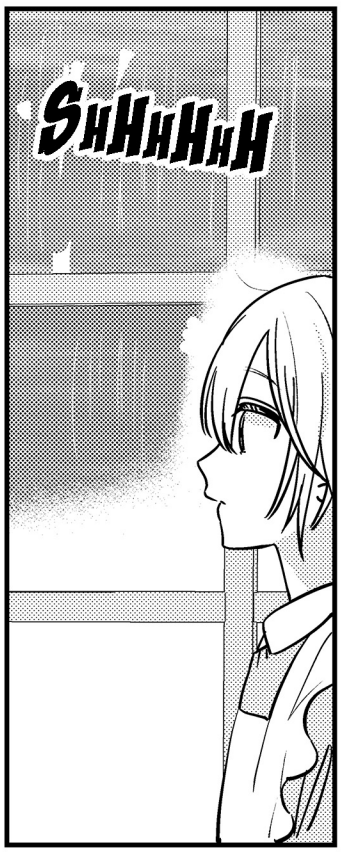

SHATTER
KYA!
SLIP
SORRY, I WASN'T PAYING ATTENTION...
IT'S DANGEROUS TO TOUCH THAT WITH YOUR BARE HANDS...
OW!
...HONESTLY.


I'LL DO IT, SO MITSURUKO, JUST STAY STILL!
SIGH...

SORRY FOR RAISING MY VOICE.
NO, IT'S OKAY.
I WONDER IF I UPSET MITSURUKO...

I'M GOING OUT FOR A BIT TODAY.
I THINK I WAS TOO HARSH YESTERDAY.
SO BEFORE MITSURUKO GETS BACK, I'LL BAKE A CAKE FOR HER AS AN APOLOGY.

I HOPE MITSURUKO GETS HOME BEFORE THE RAIN GETS WORSE...


SHHHHHH

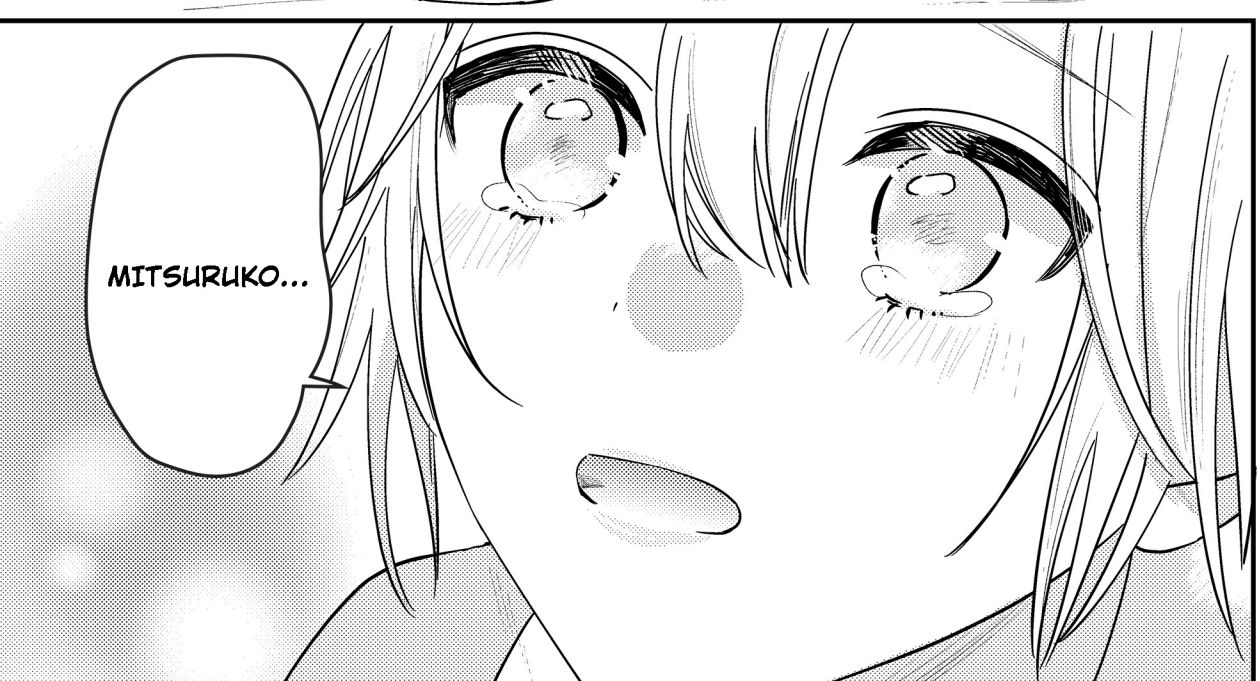
MITSURUKO STILL ISN'T BACK...
SHE DIDN'T GET INTO AN ACCIDENT OR ANYTHING, DID SHE?
SLAM
FLINCH
FLASH
OR MAYBE...
DID SHE GET SICK OF ME?

RITSU?

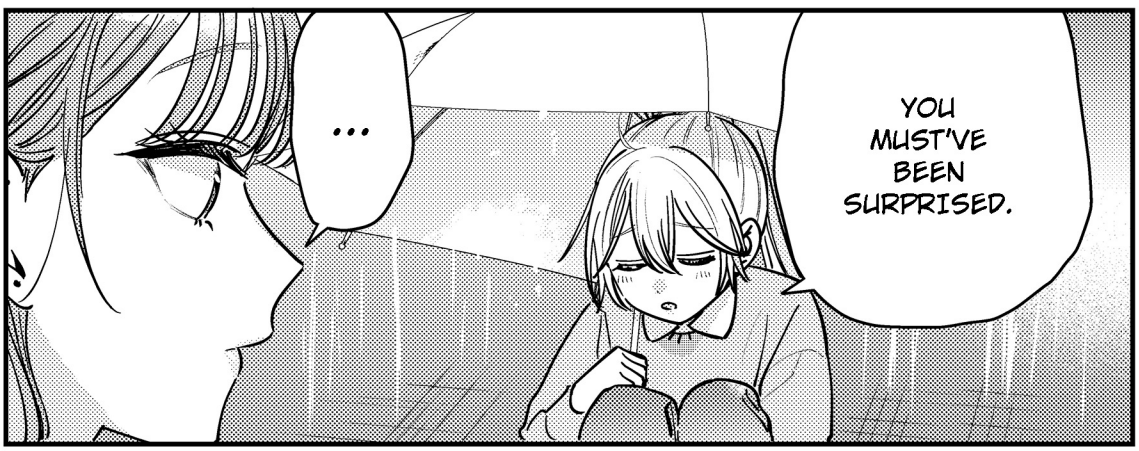
BUT BEING ALONE MAKES IT FEEL THIS SCARY...

BACK WHEN I WAS HOME, I WAS ALWAYS WITH MY FAMILY, SO I WAS FINE...

WHAT ARE YOU DOING OUT HERE?


MITSURUKO...

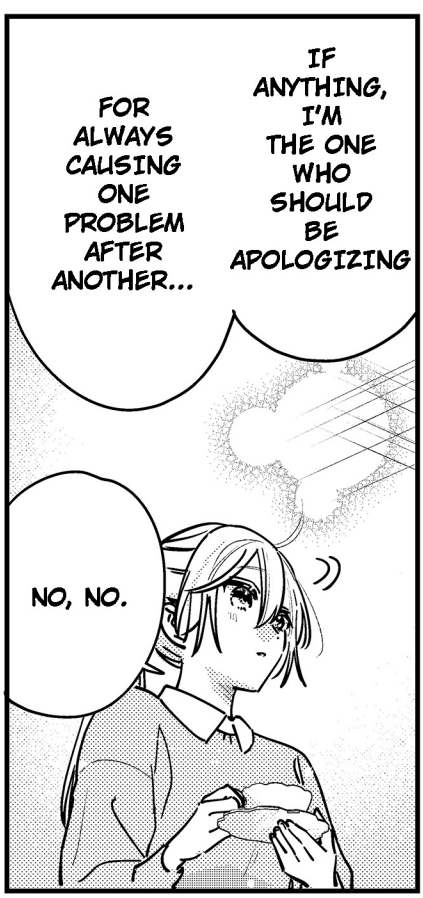
I'M SORRY FOR SNAPPING AT YOU YESTERDAY~
HUH?

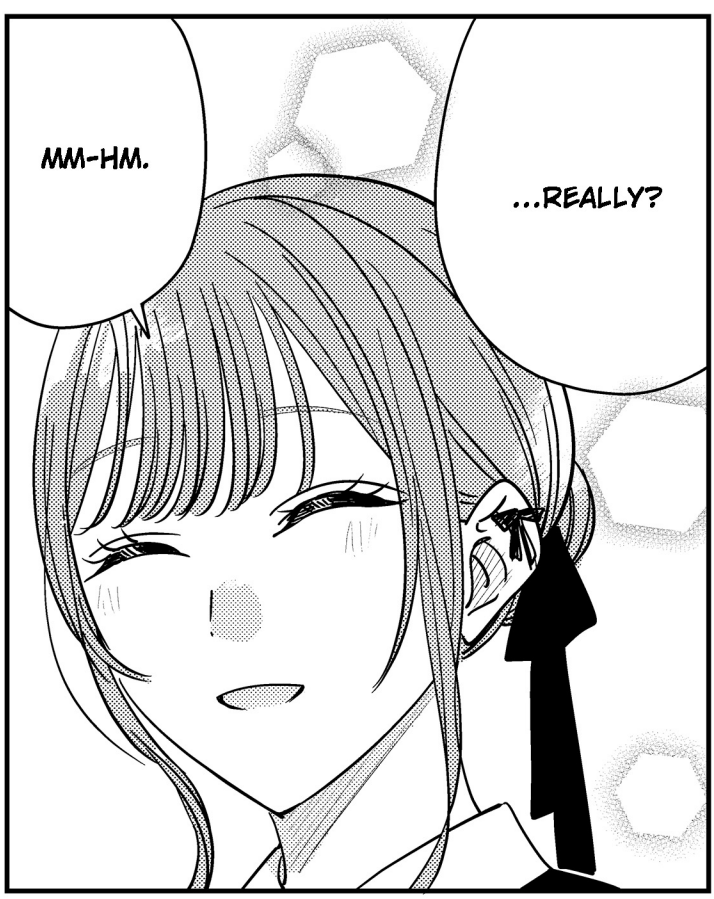

YOU MUST'VE BEEN SURPRISED.
...

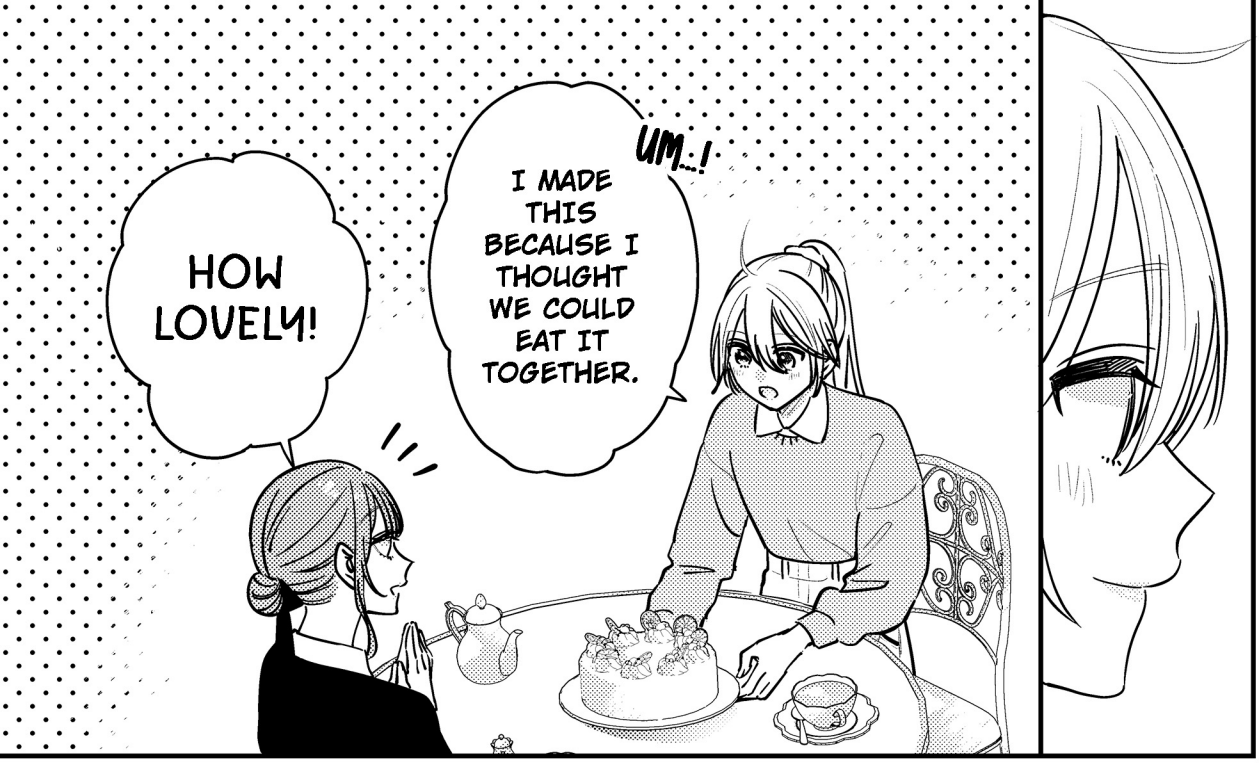
I BOUGHT SOME TEA.
LET'S DRINK IT TOGETHER.

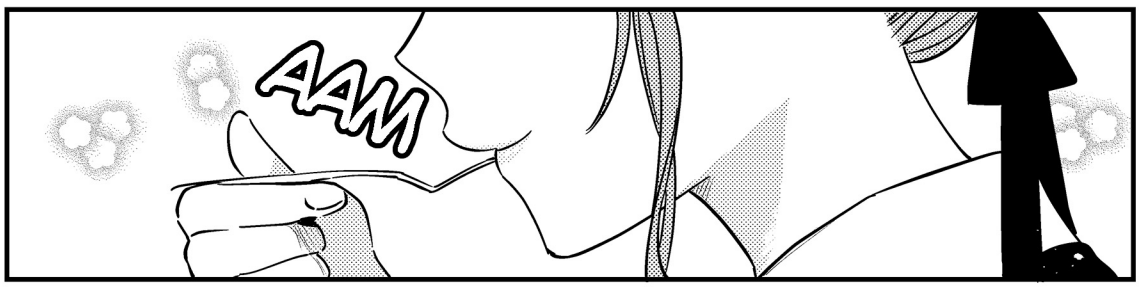
I'M ACTUALLY REALLY GOOD AT MAKING TEA.
IT'S DELICIOUS...
YESTERDAY, YOU KNOW...
I WAS HAPPY THAT YOU SAID THOSE THINGS BECAUSE YOU CARED ABOUT ME, RITSU.

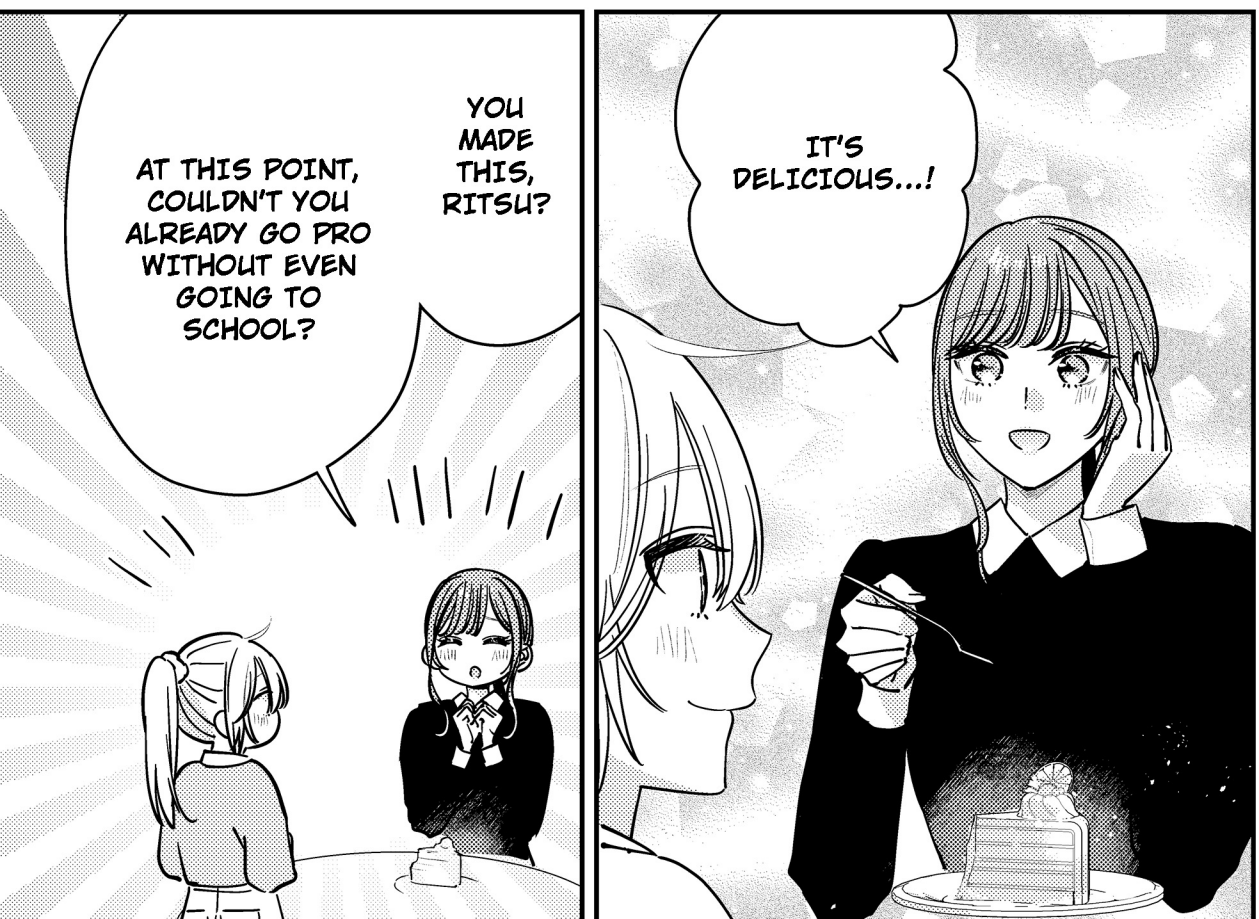
IT MADE ME FEEL LIKE MAYBE WE WERE GETTING CLOSER.


NO, NO.
FOR ALWAYS CAUSING ONE PROBLEM AFTER ANOTHER...
IF ANYTHING, I'M THE ONE WHO SHOULD BE APOLOGIZING


MM-HM.
...REALLY?


HOW LOVELY!
UM..!
I MADE THIS BECAUSE I THOUGHT WE COULD EAT IT TOGETHER.


AAM


YOU MADE THIS, RITSU?
AT THIS POINT, COULDN'T YOU ALREADY GO PRO WITHOUT EVEN GOING TO SCHOOL?
IT'S DELICIOUS...!

THAT'S WAY TOO MUCH PRAISE.
REALLY!?
I'LL MAKE MORE FOR YOU FROM NOW ON.
AT FIRST, I WAS A LITTLE NERVOUS ABOUT THE TWO OF US LIVING TOGETHER, BUT NOW...

I THINK I'M STARTING TO REALLY LOOK FORWARD TO THIS LIFE.

OOPS~ I USED TOO MUCH DETERGENT.
...THOUGH MAYBE I'M STILL A LITTLE WORRIED AFTER ALL...

THANK YOU SO MUCH FOR READING ALL THE WAY THROUGH! LAST TIME I HANDLED THE ARTWORK, BUT THIS TIME I WAS IN CHARGE OF THE STORYBOARD! IT WAS REALLY REFRESHING, AND EXCITING, TO SEE MY STORYBOARDS DRAWN WITH MEI-SENSEI'S ARTWORK ♡

– SATSUKI HARU

咲月晴

LAST TIME I HANDLED THE ARTWORK, BUT THIS TIME I WAS IN CHARGE OF THE STORYBOARD! I THINK THIS CHAPTER LET US SHOW THE GIRLS' PERSONALITIES AND RELATIONSHIP EVEN MORE DEEPLY THAN LAST TIME. WHILE WORKING ON IT, I BROKE MY WASHING MACHINE AND SHATTERED A CUP, SO I ENDED UP PULLING A VERY MITSURUKO KIND OF BLUNDER MYSELF... BUT SOMEHOW, I MANAGED TO SURVIVE IT WITH THE POWER OF THE MITSURUKO MINDSET!

– MEI FUJIMATSU

藤松 眉

CHARACTER SPOTLIGHTS

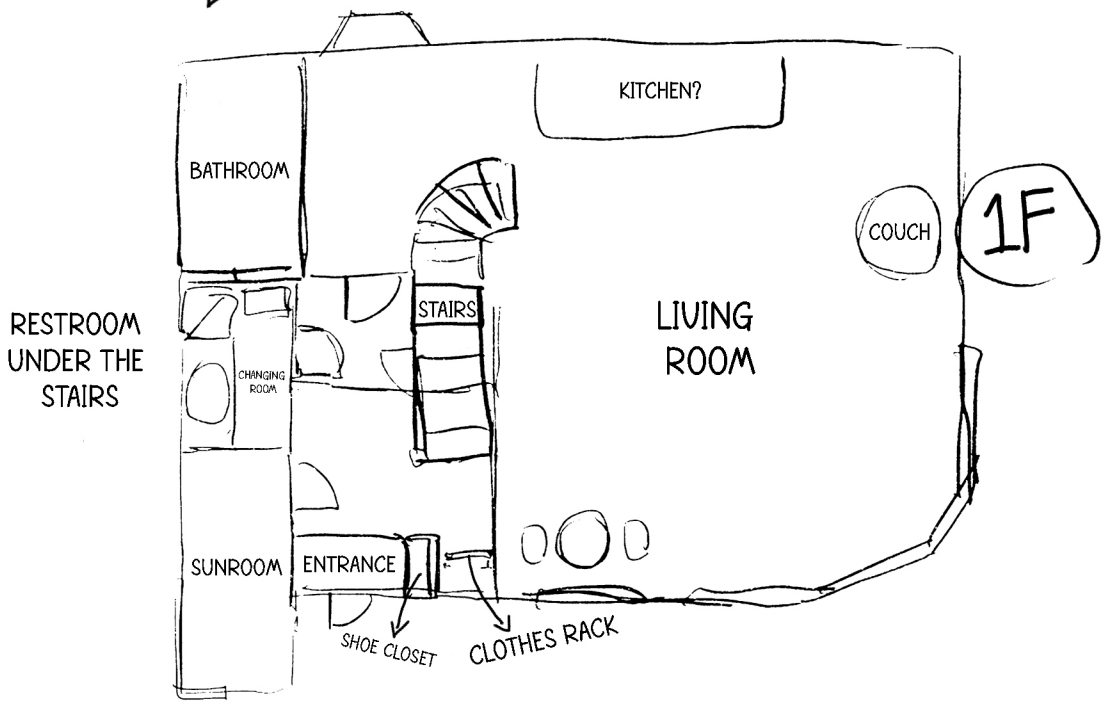
RITSU SERIZAWA (19)

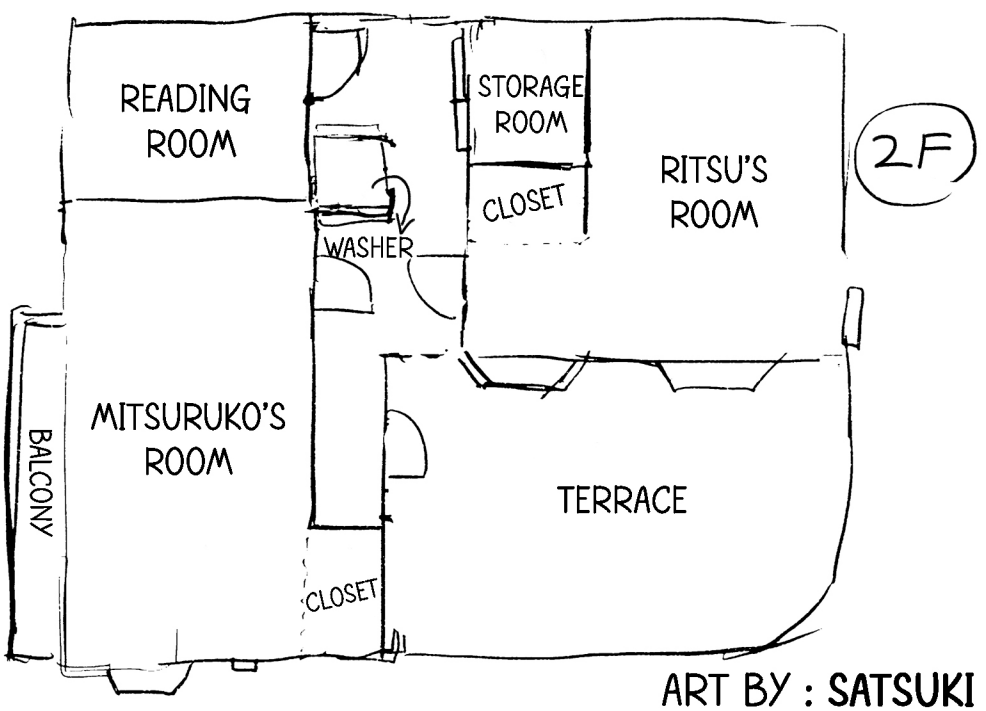
MOVED TO TOKYO
CONFECTIONERY VOCATIONAL STUDENT
WORKS PART-TIME AT A SWEETS SHOP
SHARES A HOME WITH MITSURUKO

MITSURUKO HITOTSUMICHIMIYA

AROUND 25 YEARS OLD
A REFINED YOUNG LADY
RECENTLY MOVED OUT OF HER FAMILY HOME AND IS TRYING DIFFERENT THINGS

LAYOUT OF THE HOUSE





ART BY : SATSUKI HARU

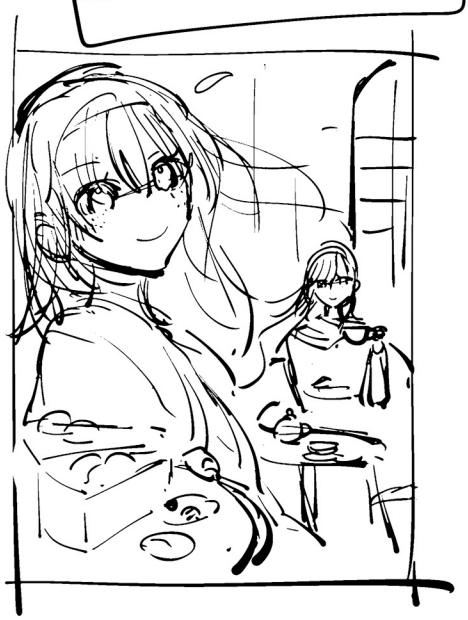
作：咲月晴

- DETACHED HOUSE
- WITH A BALCONY
- WITH A YARD

EXTERIOR VIEW

BY : SATSUKI HARU
作：咲月晴

INITIAL COVER DRAFTS



BY : MEI FUJIMATSU
作：藤松盟